Worked for 30s ›

Yes—this is the better direction. The smaller atolls have powerful stories, but they are often buried in academic papers, museum archives, family recordings and books that are difficult to find online.

Here is the first obscure-island catalog using the same credibility format.

Grades:

- **A — Strong:** Reliable source and clear island connection.
- **B — Established:** Genuine island tradition, but several versions exist.
- **C — Research lead:** Promising, but needs confirmation from an islander, cultural adviser or original-language source before publication.

Tokelau

Tokelau consists of the three main atolls of **Atafu, Nukunonu and Fakaofo**. Although Tokelauans share a language and culture, each atoll maintains its own identity and versions of stories. Academic fieldwork documented approximately 150 Tokelauan narrative texts, representing around 80 distinct stories. Tokelau narrative research ↗

Atoll and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type
Atafu	**Tae-a-Tagaloa**	An underestimated supernatural elder joins a canoe fleet. He clears a magically blackened sky, summons coconuts from above and saves the only canoe that survives.	Recorded from Mika of Atafu and later from his daughter and grandson
Nukunonu	**Taetagaloa**	Nukunonu narrators preserve a related version in which Taetagaloa uses supernatural knowledge to guide and save voyagers.	Recorded directly from Nukunonu storytellers
Nukunonu	**Kui and Fakatakā**	A local version of the Taetagaloa story, named for characters within the voyage. Its telling differs from the Atafu family version.	Indigenous-language field recording
Fakaofo waters	**Fakatakā and Pāua**	Two elders argue over the correct voyaging route and plunge into the sea, where they transform into giant clams.	Tokelauan-language narrative tied to Fakaofo reef markers
Fakaofo: Fenualoa and Fenuafala	**The Supernatural Reef Markers**	People and sea creatures become permanent features that help navigators find Fakaofo.	Place-based navigation narrative
Fakaofo	**Tui Tokelau**	The god or sacred power known as Tui Tokelau was associated especially with Fakaofo and a sacred coral slab.	Religious and place tradition
Atafu, Nukunonu and Fakaofo	**The Creation of the Atolls**	Tokelauan creation traditions explain the appearance of the low coral islands and their relationship with the sea, gods and ancestral beings. Versions differ by atoll.	Tokelauan oral traditions and museum research

Atoll and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type
Atafu	**The Raconteur Mika's Story Cycle**	Mika and his descendants preserved stories of gods, transformation, dangerous voyages and supernatural tests.	Named family line of storyteller
Olohega/Swains Island	**The Fourth Island of the Tokelauan World**	Tokelauan tradition includes Olohega within the ancestral homeland even though it is now administered as part of American Samoa. Creation and ownership accounts remain culturally sensitive.	Genealogical and political oral tradition

An excellent opening for the Atafu episode would be:

> "This story was recorded on Atafu, one of Tokelau's three remote atolls. It was preserved by the storyteller Mika and later told by members of his own family..."

That is unusually strong provenance for an oral tradition.

Niue

Niue's stories center on an elevated reef that was raised from the sea by supernatural beings. Niue's official tourism authority, Te Papa and academic research all preserve versions of the creation story. Niue's account ↗, Te Papa's Niue collection ↗

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Niue: island-wide	**Huanaki and Fao Raise Niue**	The two beings find a reef, stamp or work upon it and cause dry land and vegetation to emerge.	Official Niuean and museum accounts	A
Niue: reef caverns	**The Five Gods Bail the Ocean Away**	Fao, Huanaki, Laga-iki, Lagi-atea and Fakahoko bail water from the reef into underground caverns until Niue becomes habitable.	Te Papa museum account	A
Niue: Avatele version	**The Gods Emerge from Beneath the Earth**	Instead of arriving across the sea, the five beings emerge from underground and attempt to control the tides.	Village-specific tradition recorded by ethnographers	A
Niue: reef below the cliffs	**Fao Rises from the Sacred Pool**	Fao enters or emerges beneath a pool at the foot of Niue's cliffs and climbs upward to establish his home.	Recorded Niuean tradition	B
Niue	**Huanaki Commands the Tide**	Other beings fail to drive back the ocean. Huanaki joins Fao, and together they cause the water to withdraw.	Niuean creation cycle	B

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Niue: Motu and Tafiti divisions	**The Two Supernatural Ancestors**	Huanaki becomes associated with one part of Niue and Fao with the other.	Ancestral and supernatural tradition	B
Niue	**The Fire Gods of Fonuagalo**	Supernatural beings leave the “Hidden Land” of Fonuagalo and travel to Niue.	Official Niuean cultural account	A
Niue	**Fakahoko, the Warrior God**	One of Niue’s five principal beings becomes associated with war and supernatural protection.	Recorded religious tradition	B
Niue	**The Gods Denied Their Feast**	The five lazy beings refuse to help prepare food, receive no share and leave to find an island of their own.	Niuean explanatory legend	B

Tuvalu’s individual islands

Tuvalu has nine island communities: Nanumea, Nanumaga, Niutao, Nui, Vaitupu, Nukufetau, Funafuti, Nukulaelae and Niulakita. Each community has its own origin traditions. Te Papa’s Tuvalu overview ↗

Nanumea

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Nanumea	**Tefolaha, the Human-Spirit Ancestor**	Tefolaha arrives from Tonga and finds the island occupied by two supernatural women.	Nanumean oral tradition and published national history	A
Nanumea	**Pai and Vau**	Tefolaha challenges Pai and Vau to a contest: whoever discovers the others’ names can possess the island. He tricks the women into revealing their names.	Nanumean oral tradition	A
Nanumea: Te Motu Foliki, Lafogaki and Teaafua a Taepoa	**The Spilled Baskets of Sand**	As Pai and Vau depart, sand spills from their baskets and forms smaller islets.	Place-specific creation legend	A
Nanumea: southwest reef flat	**Lapi Defeats Tuulapoupou**	Lapi faces a giant and calls upon the spirit of Tefolaha for supernatural assistance.	Nanumean family and ceremonial tradition	A
Nanumea	**Kaumaile, the**	Tefolaha’s sacred spear carries supernatural power and is used	Tradition attached to a	A

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
	Miraculous Spear	against the giant Tuulapoupou.	significant cultural object	

Nanumaga

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Nanumaga	**Tepuhi, the Sea-Serpent Ancestor**	Tepuhi arrives from Fiji in the form of a great sea serpent and becomes associated with the island’s beginning.	Nanumagan origin tradition	A
Nanumaga	**The Spirit Beneath the Island**	Versions describe the island’s founding power as a supernatural sea creature rather than an ordinary settler.	Local creation tradition with several versions	B

Nui

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Nui: eleven principal islets	**The Spirits Raise Nui**	A company of spirits raises Nui’s eleven islets from the floor of the ocean.	Nui creation tradition	A
Nui	**The Island-Building Spirits**	The spirits organize the pieces of land before human ancestors arrive aboard the canoe Vakatiumalie.	Creation and voyaging cycle	B

Funafuti and Vaitupu

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Funafuti	**Telematua the Giant**	A giant associated with Samoa becomes the founding supernatural figure of Funafuti.	Funafuti origin tradition	B
Vaitupu	**Telematua Raises or Settles the Island**	Vaitupu preserves its own version of the giant Telematua as a founding figure.	Vaitupu oral tradition	B

Tuvalu-wide

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
The eight traditionally	**The Eel and the Flounder**	The eel and flounder fight. The crushed flounder becomes the model for flat	Tuvaluan creation tradition	A

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
inhabited islands of Tuvalu		atolls, while the eel becomes the model for the coconut tree.		
Tuvalu island chain	**The Eight Pieces of the Stone**	The eel breaks a magical stone into eight pieces, creating the eight traditionally inhabited islands —“eight standing together.”	National creation legend	A
Tuvalu island chain	**The Creation of Night, Day, Sky and Sea**	The eel repeatedly throws the stone upward, producing night, daylight, the blue sky and the ocean.	Tuvaluan cosmology	A

The Eel and Flounder story should be introduced as **Tuvaluan**, not assigned to Funafuti unless a Funafuti narrator’s version is being used.

Rotuma

Rotuma is culturally distinct from Fiji and has its own language, ancestral system and spirit traditions.

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Rotuma: island-wide	**Raho Creates Rotuma**	The ancestral being Raho arrives and uses baskets of earth or supernatural power to establish parts of the island.	Rotuman origin tradition	B
Rotuma: western and eastern districts	**Raho and the Division of the Land**	Raho’s actions explain districts, chiefly relationships and physical features.	Place and genealogy tradition	B
Rotuma	**Hanit, the Spirits of the Island**	Invisible beings inhabit particular trees, rocks, shorelines and isolated places.	Living Rotuman spirit tradition	B
Rotuma: offshore islets	**Spirit Islands and Vanishing Canoes**	Certain islets and reefs are connected with spirit encounters and voyagers who disappear or return altered.	Family and seafaring accounts	C
Rotuma	**The Woman Taken by a Hanit**	Stories describe humans entering relationships with spirits or being carried into the invisible world.	Rotuman family-story cycle	C

For Rotuma, I would want a Rotuman reviewer before turning these into scripts. The traditions are real, but much of the detailed material is preserved inside family accounts rather than reliable public summaries.

‘Uvea/Wallis and Futuna

The Wallis and Futuna tourism authority preserves several traditional *fagana*—stories once told by grandparents to children during the evening. Wallis and Futuna traditional legends ↗

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
‘Uvea/Wallis	**Tagaloa Nets the Island**	Tagaloa casts a fishing net and pulls up an entire country instead of fish.	Official island legend	A
‘Uvea/Wallis	**Tagaloa Flattens ‘Uvea**	Angry that his catch is not a fish, Tagaloa stamps upon the land until Wallis becomes flat.	Official island legend	A
‘Uvea/Wallis: surrounding reef	**Tagaloa’s Net Becomes the Barrier Reef**	The abandoned fishing net becomes the coral barrier surrounding Wallis.	Place-specific creation legend	A
Futuna: Mount Puke	**The Turtle of Mount Puke**	Rival sides hold a fishing contest to determine ownership of the mountain. One carries an enormous turtle to the summit.	Official Futunan legend	A
Futuna: Vainifao River/Mount Puke	**The Whale Turned to Stone**	The losing side abandons an enormous whale, which can still be seen as stone near the mountain.	Physical-landmark tradition	A
Futuna/Alofi tradition	**The Origin of Kava**	A new plant grows from the grave of a sacrificed girl and becomes kava.	Officially presented traditional legend	A

Nauru

Nauru has an unusually useful resource: the national government publishes several traditional stories directly.

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Nauru	**Areop-Enap, the Spider Creator**	The spider creator separates or produces the sky, earth and sea from the primordial world.	Nauruan creation tradition	A
Nauru	**Eigigu’s Tree Reaches the Sky**	Eigigu’s tears cause a tree to grow all the way into the heavens.	Nauruan national tradition	A
Nauru: sky world	**Eigigu Restores Enibarara’s Sight**	Eigigu meets a blind woman in the sky and restores her vision.	Nauruan story cycle	A

Island and place	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Nauru: moon	**Eigigu Marries Maramen**	Eigigu marries the moon and can still be seen held in his arms.	Nauruan celestial legend	A
Nauru: sea and Damo	**Detora, King of the Sea**	Detora dives to an underwater ancestral home and receives a magical hook carried in his grandfather's mouth.	Government-published Nauruan story	A
Nauru: waters near Damo	**Detora Hooks the Whale**	Detora speaks magic words over the hook, catches a whale and is carried to another island.	Government-published Nauruan story	A
Nauru	**Buitani, Island of the Dead**	Spirits of the dead inhabit a separate island or spiritual realm and may communicate through mediums.	Nauruan religious tradition	B

Government of Nauru: Detora ↗

Northern Cook Islands

These northern atolls are culturally different enough that their stories should not simply be labeled "Cook Islands legends."

Island or atoll	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
Pukapuka	**Te Ulu o Te Watu—Head of the Rock**	Creation and naming traditions describe Pukapuka as the head or summit of a foundational rock.	Pukapukan place tradition	B
Pukapuka	**The Flood and Survival on the High Mound**	Island traditions remember overwhelming seas and a small surviving population. Versions may mix environmental memory with supernatural narrative.	Oral tradition with possible environmental basis	B
Manihiki	**The Island Drawn from the Sea**	An ancestral or supernatural figure brings the atoll into existence.	Manihikian origin tradition	C
Rakahanga	**The Shared Beginning of Rakahanga and Manihiki**	The two atolls are treated as related lands connected by the same ancestors and supernatural origins.	Inter-island oral tradition	B
Penrhyn/Tongareva	**The Sacred Turtle and the Lagoon**	Turtle, shark and lagoon-spirit traditions explain	Local marine traditions	C

Island or atoll	Tradition	Story details	Source type	Grade
		sacred relationships with marine animals.		
Palmerston	**Pre-European Spirits of the Atoll**	Stories concerning earlier Polynesian presences and spirits survive alongside the later Marsters family history.	Fragmentary place traditions	C
Suwarrow	**The Deserted Atoll and Its Spirits**	Voyagers describe supernatural presences and warnings connected with the isolated atoll.	Seafarer and later folklore; requires caution	C

Other islands worth adding next

The next research group should include:

- **Banaba**
- **Onotoa**
- **Tabiteuea**
- **Abemama**
- **Butaritari**
- **Makin**
- **Kuria**
- **Aranuka**
- **Nikumaroro**
- **Kapingamarangi**
- **Nukuoro**
- **Mokil**
- **Pingelap**
- **Sapwuahfik**
- **Ifalik**
- **Woleai**
- **Lamotrek**
- **P ulap**
- **P ulusuk**
- **P ulawat**
- **Satawal**
- **Ulithi**
- **Fais**
- **Sonsorol**
- **Tobi**
- **Rennell**
- **Bellona**
- **Tikopia**
- **Anuta**
- **Ontong Java**

Those islands are exactly where you will find stories most viewers have never heard. The strongest immediate episodes from this group are:

1. **Taetagaloa Saves the Last Canoe — Atafu, Tokelau**
2. **Fakatakā and Pāua Become Giant Clams — Fakaofo, Tokelau**

3. **The Five Gods Raise Niue from the Sea**
4. **Tefolaha Tricks Pai and Vau — Nanumea**
5. **Tepuhi the Sea Serpent — Nanumaga**
6. **The Spirits Raise the Eleven Islets of Nui**
7. **The Eel and Flounder Create Tuvalu**
8. **Tagaloa Pulls ‘Uvea from the Ocean**
9. **The Whale Turned to Stone — Futuna**
10. **Eigigu Climbs a Tree to the Moon — Nauru**
11. **Detora Receives the Magic Hook — Nauru**
12. **Raho Creates Rotuma**

These are obscure, island-specific and visually strong—the exact combination that could make the storytelling channel different from generic mythology content.